Foundation Staff Project

Specification Template Instructions

DRAFT

Informational
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Revision History

Revision	Date	Author(s)	Description
xx	YYYY/MM/dd	Names(s)	Text
xx	YYYY/MM/dd	Names(s)	Text
xx	YYYY/MM/dd	Names(s)	Text

Formatting

The specification must follow the template format and meet the additional requirements below:

- Text color shall be black
- font shall be rendered as TBD (Calibri)
  - body text TBDpt (12pt)
  - Heading 1 TBDpt
  - ...
- Bold, underline, italics and other font modifiers are allowed as needed for clarity & emphasis

Title Page

This section is mandatory.
The title page shall have the specification name, the revision, the publication date, as well as the enumeration of authors.

Providing a project, sub-project, or workstream designation is optional since the contribution process already records the relevant project in the listing.

Limit the entry for each Author to their name and, if desired, their company affiliation or approved designation (such as “individual”) if unaffiliated. Marketing elements, including logos or promotional content, are not permitted.

Table of Contents

This section is mandatory.
The table of contents shall enumerate the primary and secondary sections of the specification.

Table of Figures

This section is mandatory.
The table of figures shall enumerate the figures within the main body of the specification. The only exception is when no figures are used, this section shall be omitted.

Table of Tables

This section is mandatory.
The table of tables shall enumerate the tables within the main body of the specification. The only exception is when no tables are used, this section shall be omitted.

Revision History

This section is mandatory.
Record revision, publish date, authors and the high level changes made for the revision. You may have an appendix with a more detailed change enumeration if you desire.

1 Acknowledgements

This section is mandatory.

List all contributors (CLA signatories), as well as companies or individuals who may have assisted you with the specification by providing feedback and suggestions but did not provide any IP. Limit the entry for each contributor to their name and, if desired, their company affiliation or approved designation (such as “individual”) if unaffiliated. Marketing elements, including logos or promotional content, are not permitted.

2 Copyright / Trademark

This section is mandatory.

Explicitly list all trademarks referenced in the specification. If none are applicable, use "None" or "N/A".

While the preferred approach is to reference third-party material (see specification guidelines), if any allowable copyrighted material is utilized, include the required copyright notice in this section. If none are applicable, use "None" or "N/A.".

A generic statement may also be used when additional coverage is needed or when ownership is uncertain: "All trademarks, service marks, certification marks, and trade names are the property of their respective owners. Use of third-party marks is for identification only and does not imply endorsement."

3 Compliance with OCP Tenets

This section and all tenets are mandatory.

For each of the tenets, detail how your contribution aligns and supports the tenet.

3.1 Openness

Openness is measured by the ability of third parties to build, modify, or personalize your contributed device, platform, or software. The OCP aims for completely open platforms that include all programmable devices, firmware, software, mechanical and electrical design elements, and any necessary external components or tools like software utilities. Contributors are highly encouraged to collaborate with other OCP Projects that may have complementary knowledge and expertise. Actively remove barriers to openness and demonstrate collaboration by sharing, seeking feedback, and accepting changes to designs and specifications. Ensure your contribution can be extended and enhanced by others.

3.2 Efficiency

Your contribution should be more efficient than existing or prior generations. Efficiency can be demonstrated through reduced operational and capital expenses, improved performance, modularity, increased capacity, lower power or water consumption, better utilization, reduced size, or minimized code weight and latency in software. Clearly express efficiency gains with metrics valued by end-users when proposing your contribution.

3.3 Impact

Your contribution should have a transformative impact on the industry by introducing new technology, accelerating time-to-market, or enabling technology through global supply chains. Impact is amplified when new technologies are made accessible to many customers worldwide. Examples include widely adopted specifications or more specifically, open security features that establish and verify product trust. Ensure your contribution creates meaningful positive impact within the OCP ecosystem.

3.4 Scale

Design your contribution for easy implementation and deployment at any scale, with minimal intervention. Aim to create additive solutions where minimal usage or instances can be deployed and incrementally scaled as needed to effectively address the entire problem. Provide all necessary tools and supporting documentation, such as installation guides, initialization processes, configuration information, and details on obtaining service support. Include features like simple manual and automated maintenance, remote management, upgradability, and error reporting. Management tools should be open-sourced and/or made available to adopters.

3.5 Sustainability

Your contribution must be sustainable, maximizing transparency of environmental impacts with the goal of continuous improvement. Focus on the responsible use of natural resources, fostering positive societal impacts, and minimizing environmental harm. This can be achieved through design decisions that promote circularity, efficient use of materials, power-saving features, and sustainability labeling. For software, consider optimizing code to reduce resource consumption and incorporating features that enable energy efficiency.

4 Introduction

This section and all sub-sections are mandatory.
no text necessary in this section, simply the header

4.1 Purpose of the Document

Clearly state the type of specification this is (per OCP contribution taxonomy), reason for creating this document, explain what it aims to achieve.

4.2 Scope

Define the boundaries of the document. Specify what is included and what is explicitly excluded. This helps prevent misunderstandings about coverage.

4.3 Audience

Identify the intended readers and their roles. This could include architects, engineers, developers, project managers, etc.

4.4 Conventions

This section lists the standard conventions used in this specification.
Normative language is mandatory, no modifications are necessary to this text. Add in other conventions utilized in the specification (numerical representation etc.)

5 Overview

This section is mandatory.

This section provides a high-level summary of the system or solution. It sets the context for the entire specification and explains what the solution is intended to achieve.

5.1 Description

This section is mandatory.

Provide a concise explanation of what the system or solution is, including its primary function and role within the larger ecosystem. Include the problems it addresses. Explain its utility within the Open Compute Project ecosystem.

5.2 Goals, Vision, Objectives

This section is mandatory. Define the long-term vision and goals for the system or solution. Outline measurable objectives that guide decisions. This helps consumers of the specification understand the problem being addressed and how the solution fits into the broader context.

5.3 User Requirements/User Stories

This section is optional.

Capture what end-users or stakeholders need from the system. This can be expressed as high-level requirements or user stories to ensure the architecture aligns with real-world needs.

If end-user stories or requirements we not utilized in the definition, then this section need not be present and the Goals, Visions, Objectives section will suffice.

5.4 Solution Architecture

This section is optional.

Present the high-level design of the solution, including major components, their interactions, and how they fulfill the goals and requirements. This section often includes diagrams (e.g., system context, component diagrams).

For fundamental architectural level specifications, this section should be present and would evolve with revision progression.

6 Main Section A

The sections labeled “Main Sections” constitute the main body of the document and are intentionally generic, allowing the author(s) to adapt them to the specific needs of the project. These sections should define requirements across multiple domains and may be organized in a structure that best supports the specification’s objectives.

Examples of sections within the main body:

- HW specification: may address domains such as performance, mechanical, electrical, thermal, manageability, security, reliability, and regulatory compliance.
- SW specification: May cover domains such as data architecture, interfaces & protocols, performance & scalability, security, maintainability, test & validation.
- Domain level base specification: Could incorporate any or all of the above examples customized to meet the requirements of the specific dmain.

7 Main Section B

8 Main Section C

9 Compliance

This section is mandatory. Define explicitly what it means to be compliant with the specification.
A base specification should describe what a design must accomplish to achieve compliance.
A design specification should describe how it satisfies the base specification (as applicable) and define what a product must implement to be compliant.
A Product specifications should describe how it satisfies the compliance requirements of the corresponding design specification.

Ideally, compliance should be presented as a table that summarizes all requirements, clearly indicating whether each is mandatory or optional.

10 License

This section is mandatory.

The template language is fixed, the only action necessary is to enumerate companies who have signed the CLA to participate in the contribution.

Note that contributing companies must be OCP members.

Appendix A: Glossary and Abbreviations

This section is mandatory.

Enumerate all unique definitions and abbreviations utilized in the specification.

Appendix B: References

This section is mandatory unless no references.

Enumerate & cross-link references throughout the specification. rendering will generate this based on the YAML file

Appendix C: Another Appendix Section

This section is optional.

Use additional sub-sections for other detail which need to be captured